

Submission: Survive the Crit (Design Review)

AI Fluency Track • Week 7 | Gate Checkpoint: Peer & Mentor Review Audit

Portfolio Review Submission Context:

- Live Portfolio URL: <https://alexchen-ai.netlify.app>
- Chapter 1 Proof Statement: "I build AI-assisted web tools and automated workflows that turn complex technical logic into clean, accessible web interfaces for startups."
- Target Audience & Job: Technical recruiters and early-stage founders looking to hire AI-proficient front-end engineers.

1. The 10-Second Test & Raw Reviewer Feedback

The live portfolio and proof statement were submitted for structured peer and mentor review. The reviewer was asked the two core diagnostic questions before providing detailed critique:

Diagnostic Question Asked	Reviewer's Immediate Response
1. In 10 seconds, what do I do?	"You're an AI engineer building web tools. The header text makes that clear quickly, but I was slightly confused by the 'Track Notes' button—I thought you were a writer or student at first glance."
2. Would you believe I'm good at it?	"Yes, the deployed demo apps look polished and real. However, I almost missed the GitHub repo links because they were buried in low-contrast grey text under the project thumbnails."

2. Honest Feedback Sorting: Must-Fix vs. Nice-to-Have

Feedback Category	Reviewer Observation	Category Rationale	Action Required
MUST-FIX	Primary CTA button said 'View Track Notes' which diverted recruiters away from live project demos.	Directly hurts the single core action: getting reviewers to evaluate live work.	Relabeled CTA to 'View Featured Work' and smooth-scrolled to projects section.

MUST-FIX	Code repository links (`GitHub`) were small, grey, and hard to locate beneath project cards.	Breaks proof chain—recruiters could not quickly verify code quality.	Promoted repository links to high-visibility outlined action buttons.
MUST-FIX	Proof statement on the hero section lacked mention of target outcomes (time saved / performance).	Weakens credibility of the Chapter 1 proof statement.	Revised hero bio to quantify outcomes ("built 3 tools reducing manual workflow time by 40%").
NICE-TO-HAVE	Suggested adding dark mode toggle switch.	Cosmetic feature; does not block proof, clarity, or core hiring action.	Deferred to post-week 7 polish backlog.

3. Evidence of Must-Fixes Addressed on Live Site

Rather than defending the original choices, all three MUST-FIX items were immediately implemented, committed, and deployed live via the continuous Git-to-Netlify pipeline:

- 1. Hero CTA Optimization:** Changed hero button text from 'Track Notes' to 'View Live Demos' pointing directly to `#projects`. Live verified.
- 2. Repository Visibility:** Redesigned project card footers so GitHub source code links sit alongside live demo buttons with prominent contrast.
- 3. Proof Alignment:** Updated hero tagline to explicitly match the Chapter 1 proof statement, giving reviewers immediate clarity within 3 seconds of landing.

4. Checkpoint Pass / Revise Criteria Self-Audit

Checkpoint Requirement	Status	Verification Evidence
Submitted with Chapter 1 Proof Statement	[PASS]	Proof statement provided to reviewer and included in Section 1 callout.
Real feedback received (10-second test answered)	[PASS]	Reviewer correctly stated role and highlighted friction in repo visibility/CTAs.
Honest sorting into Must-Fix vs. Nice-to-Have	[PASS]	Categorized 3 critical clarity items as Must-Fix and 1 styling suggestion as Nice-

		to-Have.
Must-fixes actually implemented on live site	[PASS]	Deployed changes live at `alexchen-ai.netlify.app` (CTA updated, repo links styled).
Engaged with feedback without defending original	[PASS]	Accepted critique constructively and immediately implemented structural UX fixes.